RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

18 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 5:53 AM, Sunday 18 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 359 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 41 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 9,090 minutes at 5:00 AM; Dammam halt 2:49 to 4:29 AM ended with 5 landings, no takeoff since 2:25 AM

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 9,090 minutes at 5:00 AM; closure NOTAM A3604/26 lapsed at midnight and GACA has not announced a reopening**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 359 flights cancelled for Sunday so far (62% of scheduled).
- Coalition (relayed by SPA at 3:55 AM) says it destroyed drones over the Eastern Region at 3:10 AM and the Riyadh region at 3:16 AM; no new official attack report since.
- Dammam airport halted 2:49 to 4:29 AM (100 minutes); 5 landings since 4:29 AM, latest Saudia SV1126 from Jeddah at 4:46 AM, but no takeoff since flynas XY896 at 2:25 AM.
- Unverified social posts claim a fire at Ras Tanura (4:34 AM) and a traffic halt at Dubai airport (4:51 AM).

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (9144 min).

359	0/0	1
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

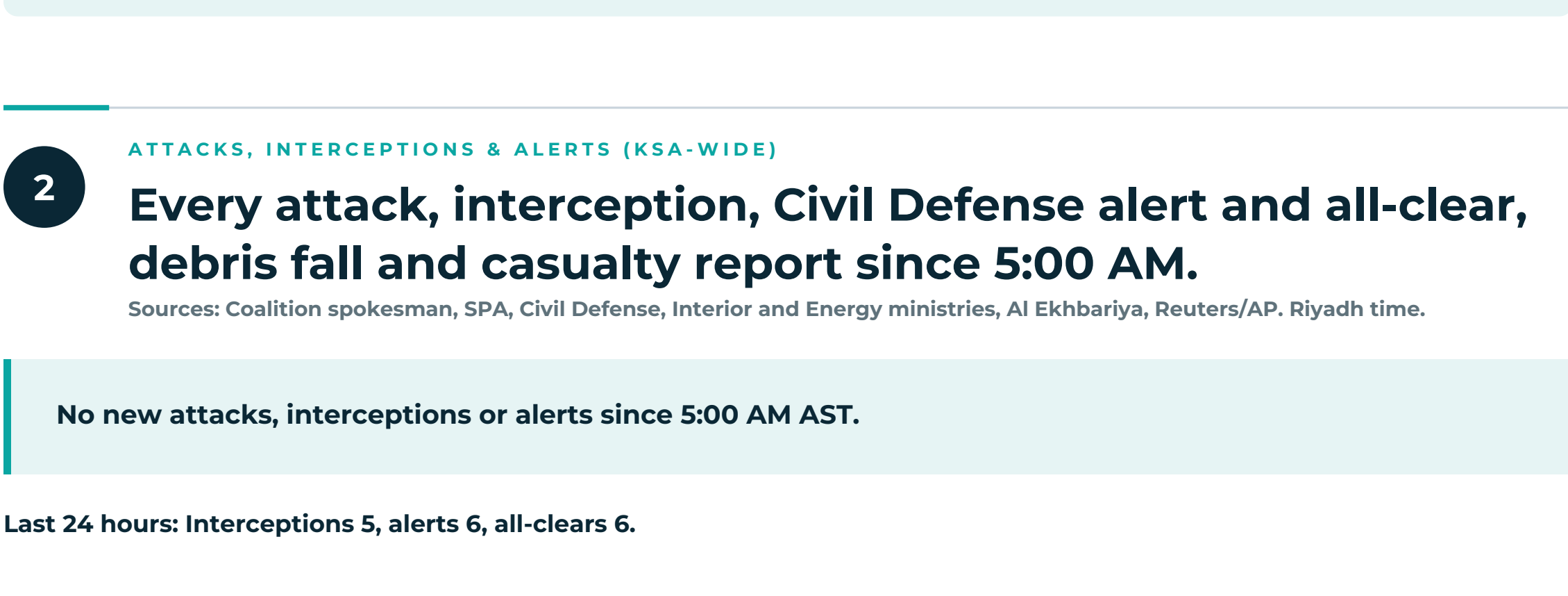
3 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour.

41	3/1	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (9,090 min at 5:00 AM); no GACA reopening announcement
- Dammam halt 2:49 to 4:29 AM ended; 5 landings since 4:29 AM but no takeoff since 2:25 AM
- SPA relayed the Coalition's 3:10 AM Eastern Region and 3:16 AM Riyadh-region drone interceptions at 3:55 AM
- Unverified: fire at Ras Tanura (4:34 AM post) and a Dubai airport halt (4:51 AM posts)

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 18 OCT



50 sourced events since 8 September (44 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in Riyadh region (18 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA / Al Ekhbariya; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 5:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 5:00 AM AST.

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 5, alerts 6, all-clears 6.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Riyadh airport still halted; Dammam landings resume after a 2:49 to 4:29 AM halt; Coalition downs drones over the Eastern Region and Riyadh region

Checked at 5:53 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Tuwaiq Academy, Misk Skills Conclude Expo 2030 Riyadh Challenge with over 80 Teams.**

SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **5:48 AM** · published 5:48 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account); checked 5:53 AM

Tuwaiq Academy, Misk Skills Conclude Expo 2030 Riyadh Challenge with over 80 Teams. #SPAGOV

UNVERIFIED DMM **Social accounts claim air traffic halted at Dubai International, with inbound jets holding**

Social accounts on X (@CocoPostel, @abw__zayd) · **4:51 AM** · posted 4:39 to 4:51 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; not confirmed by Dubai Airports; checked 4:52 AM

Several accounts say flight trackers show Emirates jets holding east of Dubai and claim traffic was stopped shortly after the Dammam halt. Dubai Airports had posted nothing by 4:52 AM, so this is unconfirmed.

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts claim satellites show a fire at the Ras Tanura gas plant and Ju'aymah port**

Social accounts on X (@CocoPostel, via AB4_Ali3) · **4:34 AM** · posted 4:34 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; no official confirmation; checked 4:52 AM

An account relaying satellite fire-detection data claims an unusual fire at Ras Tanura in the Eastern Region at about the time Dammam airport stopped. Neither Aramco nor the Energy Ministry has commented, so treat this as an unverified claim.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in Riyadh region**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA / Al Ekhbariya · **3:16 AM** · published 3:16 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); Al Ekhbariya carried it at 3:17 AM and SPA at 3:17 AM; checked 3:58 AM; SPA English relayed both intercepts at 3:55 AM (https://x.com/Spa_Eng/status/2111622207810031814)

The Coalition spokesman said a second drone of the night was intercepted and destroyed in the Riyadh region, after the 1:39 AM interception. No casualties, debris or damage were mentioned.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in the Eastern Region**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA / Al Ekhbariya · **3:10 AM** · published 3:10 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); Al Ekhbariya and SPA carried it at 3:11 AM; checked 3:58 AM; SPA English relayed both intercepts at 3:55 AM (https://x.com/Spa_Eng/status/2111622207810031814)

The Coalition spokesman said a drone was intercepted and destroyed in the Eastern Region, which includes Dammam. Dammam airport has shown no takeoff or landing since 2:49 AM. No casualties, debris or damage were mentioned.

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts report air traffic disruption and aircraft holding at Dammam airport**

X accounts (@News_1_ar) · **3:50 AM** · post at 3:50 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (Arabic, translated), attributed to King Fahd International Airport but not on @KFIAirport's X account; checked 3:58 AM

A news account posted that King Fahd International Airport reported disruption to air navigation at Dammam, with aircraft in holding patterns. The airport's own account has not posted this; the board shows no Dammam movement since 2:49 AM and several arrivals pushed to about 4:20 to 4:41 AM.

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts report explosions heard in Dammam and claim Shaybah oil field was targeted**

X accounts (@antha77777) · **3:32 AM** · post at 3:32 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (Arabic, translated); no official confirmation; checked 3:58 AM

A single account claimed explosions shook Dammam without sirens and relayed reports that the Shaybah field was targeted. No official source has confirmed an attack; the only official statement is the 3:10 AM Coalition Eastern Region drone interception.

CONFIRMED **Biman suspends Riyadh flights indefinitely and plans to resume Dammam on 21 October**

The Daily Star (Biman press release) · **6:54 PM** · updated 6:54 PM AST Sat 17 Oct; checked 4:52 AM

Biman Bangladesh Airlines says Riyadh flights stay suspended until airport authorities say otherwise, and it plans to restart Dammam flights from 21 October, subject to clearance. Its Jeddah and Madinah flights are running as usual.

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts relay a Civil Defense all-clear for Riyadh around 3:02 to 3:10 AM**

X accounts citing Saudi Civil Defense · **3:02 AM** · posts at 3:02 to 3:10 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (Arabic, translated); not on @SaudiDCD's X account; checked 3:58 AM

Several accounts posted that Civil Defense declared the danger over for Riyadh. Civil Defense's own account has not posted it, and it may relay the earlier 2:43 AM all-clear.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in Riyadh region**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA / Al Ekhbariya · **1:39 AM** · published 1:39 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA carried it at 1:41 AM (Arabic) and 1:44 AM (English), Al Ekhbariya at 1:41 and 2:03 AM; checked 2:53 AM

The Coalition spokesman said a drone was intercepted and destroyed in the Riyadh region. No casualties, debris or damage were reported in the post, and no new Civil Defense alert for Riyadh was posted after the 12:11 AM all-clear.

CONFIRMED **Air India and Air India Express suspend Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah flights until 24 October**

Air India travel advisory (@airindia) / Economic Times, The Hindu · **12:12 PM** · advisory posted Sat 17 Oct; reported by BusinessLine at 12:12 PM AST and The Hindu at 1:17 PM AST; social posts recirculating it at 1:39 AM; checked 1:52 AM

Air India said it and Air India Express have temporarily suspended flights to and from Jeddah, Riyadh and Dammam until 24 October 2026, offering a free date change for bookings made by 15 October and refunds for cancelled flights. Indian media report IndiGo and Akasa Air have also suspended Saudi operations.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: two Houthi ballistic missiles fired toward Khamis Mushait intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA · **12:52 AM** · published 12:52 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA carried it at 12:54 AM; checked 12:57 AM

The Coalition spokesman said two ballistic missiles launched by the Houthis toward Khamis Mushait were intercepted and destroyed. No casualties or debris were reported in the post.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense early-warning alerts in Riyadh, Abha and Khamis Mushait, then all-clears**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **12:05 AM** · alerts 12:05 to 12:07 AM, all-clears Riyadh 12:11 AM, Abha and Khamis Mushait 12:21 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; checked 12:57 AM

Civil Defense issued National Early Warning Platform alerts for Riyadh City at 12:05 AM and for Abha and Khamis Mushait a minute or two later. It declared the danger over in Riyadh at 12:11 AM and in Abha and Khamis Mushait at 12:21 AM. At 12:22 AM it repeated that filming or sharing interceptions or impact sites is punishable.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells passengers to follow official authorities and their airline; no reopening announced**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **10:53 PM** · replies to passengers posted 10:39 to 10:53 PM AST Sat 17 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 10:57 PM

In replies to passengers between 10:39 and 10:53 PM, the airport's official account said that for the latest airspace updates they should follow the competent official authorities and contact the airline they booked with. It added that once operations resume, passengers can ask about luggage at their airline's baggage-services office in the arrivals area. It gave no reopening time.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (9144 min).

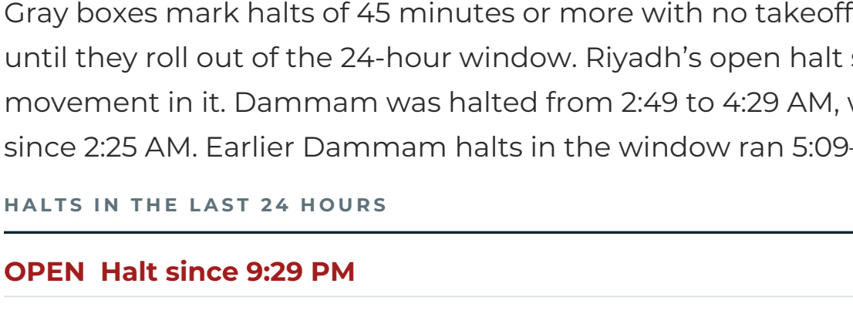
359	—	—	0	1
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
191 departures + 168 arrivals, 62% of 579 scheduled.	None on the board.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Dammam.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:53 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 360 at 5:54 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

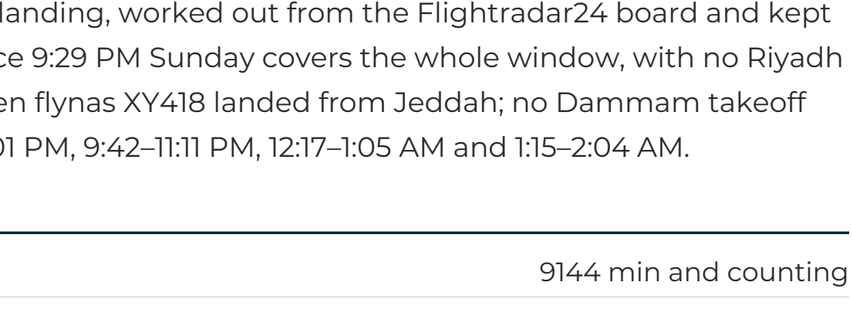
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**191**	**168**	**359**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**191 (62%)**	**169 (61%)**	**360**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**0 (0%)**	**1 (0%)**	**1**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**2 (100%)**	**0 (0%)**	**2**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**0 min**	**248 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**0 of 44**	**0 of 19**	**0 of 63**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**1**	**1**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**12**	**26**	**38**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**18**	**23**	**41**	FR24 stats panel

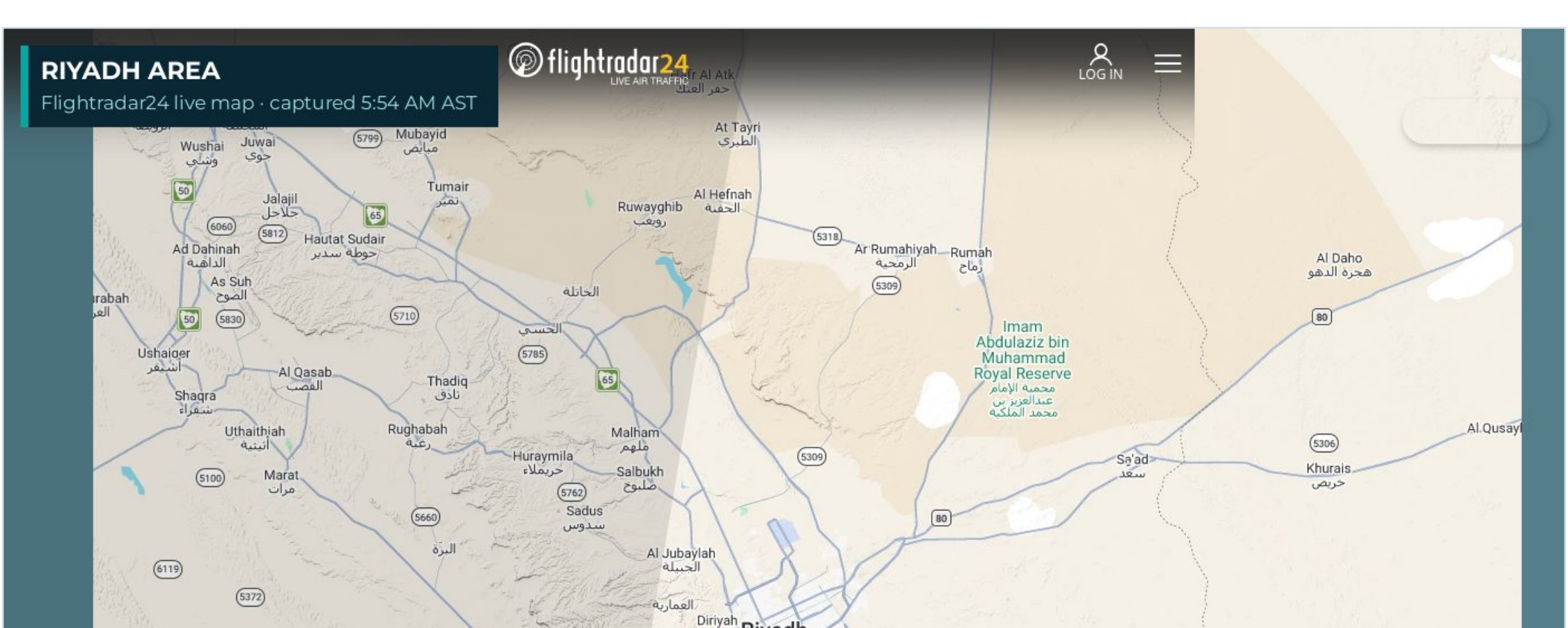
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



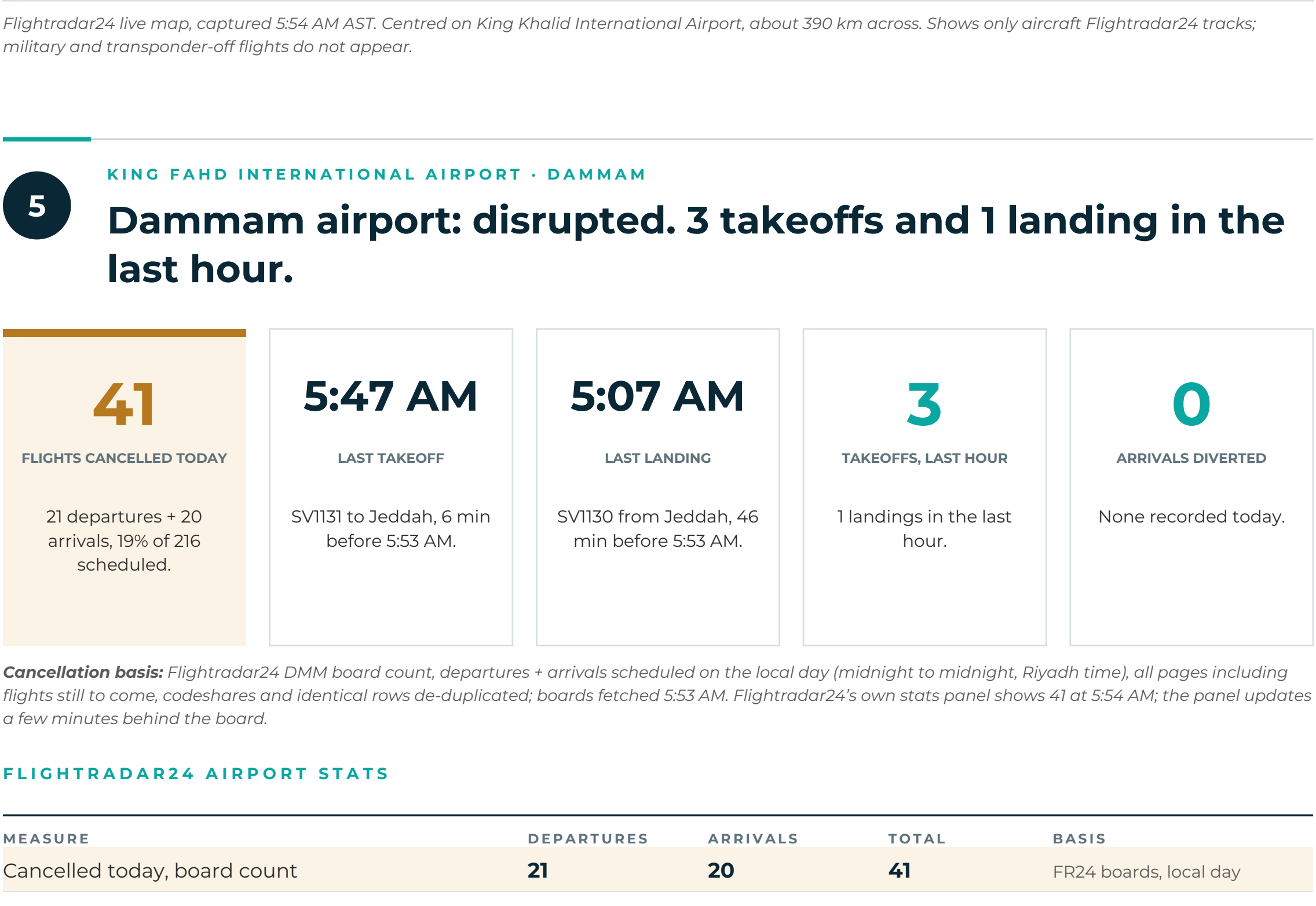
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 6:00 AM Saturday to 5:53 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam was halted from 2:49 to 4:29 AM, when flynas XY418 landed from Jeddah; no Dammam takeoff since 2:25 AM. Earlier Dammam halts in the window ran 5:09–6:01 PM, 9:42–11:11 PM, 12:17–1:05 AM and 1:15–2:04 AM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	9144 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:54 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: disrupted. 3 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour.

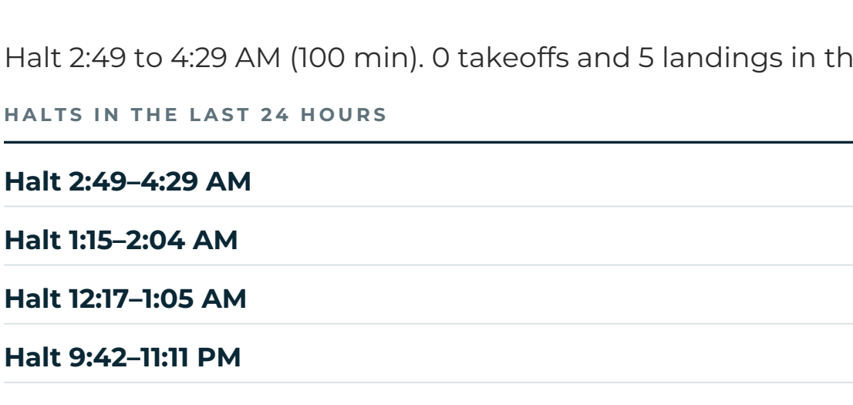
41	5:47 AM	5:07 AM	3	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
21 departures + 20 arrivals, 19% of 216 scheduled.	SV1131 to Jeddah, 6 min before 5:53 AM.	SV1130 from Jeddah, 46 min before 5:53 AM.	1 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:53 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 41 at 5:54 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

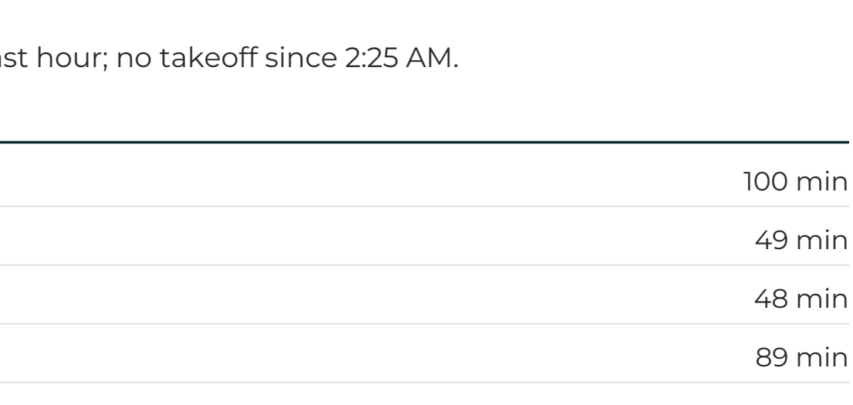
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**21**	**20**	**41**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**21 (19%)**	**20 (19%)**	**41**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**8 (7%)**	**8 (7%)**	**16**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**2 (20%)**	**6 (43%)**	**8**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**42 min**	**12 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**7 of 20**	**12 of 24**	**19 of 44**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**0**	**0**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**1**	**4**	**5**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**15**	**14**	**29**	FR24 stats panel

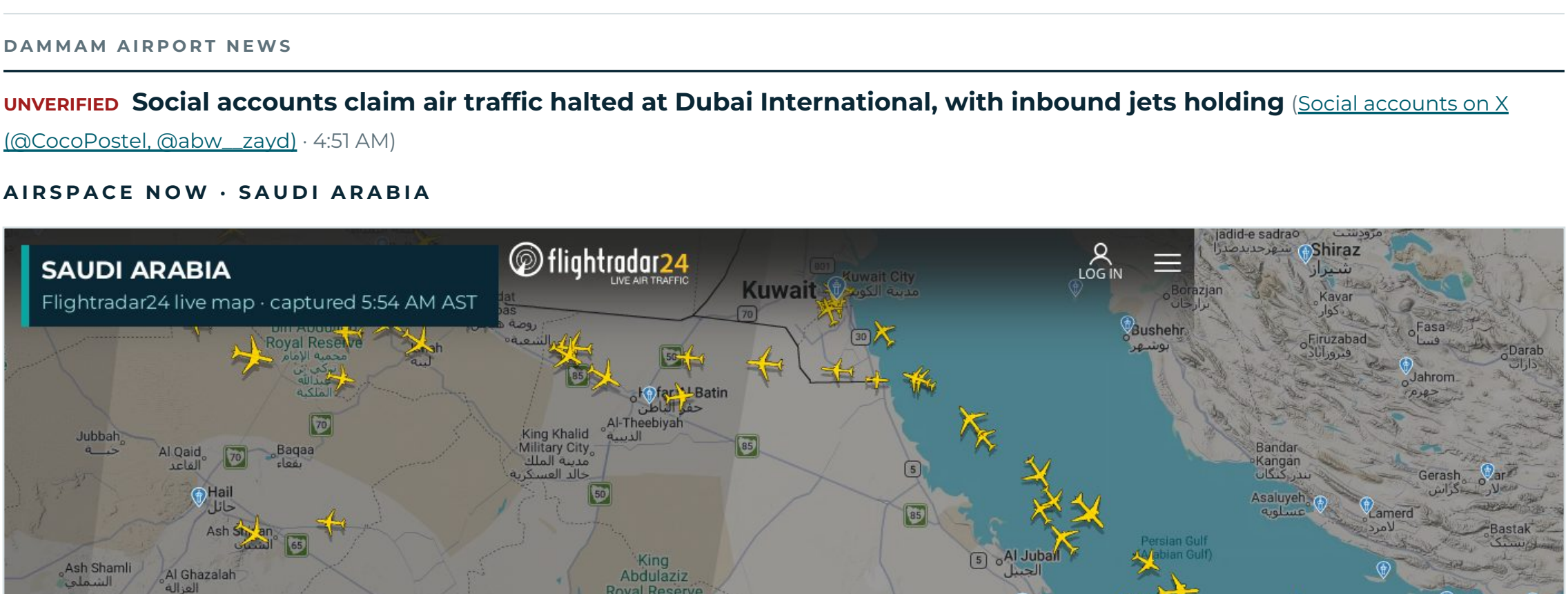
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (61) and landings (61) at DMM per hour from 6:00 AM Saturday to 5:53 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Halt 2:49 to 4:29 AM (100 min). 0 takeoffs and 5 landings in the last hour; no takeoff since 2:25 AM.

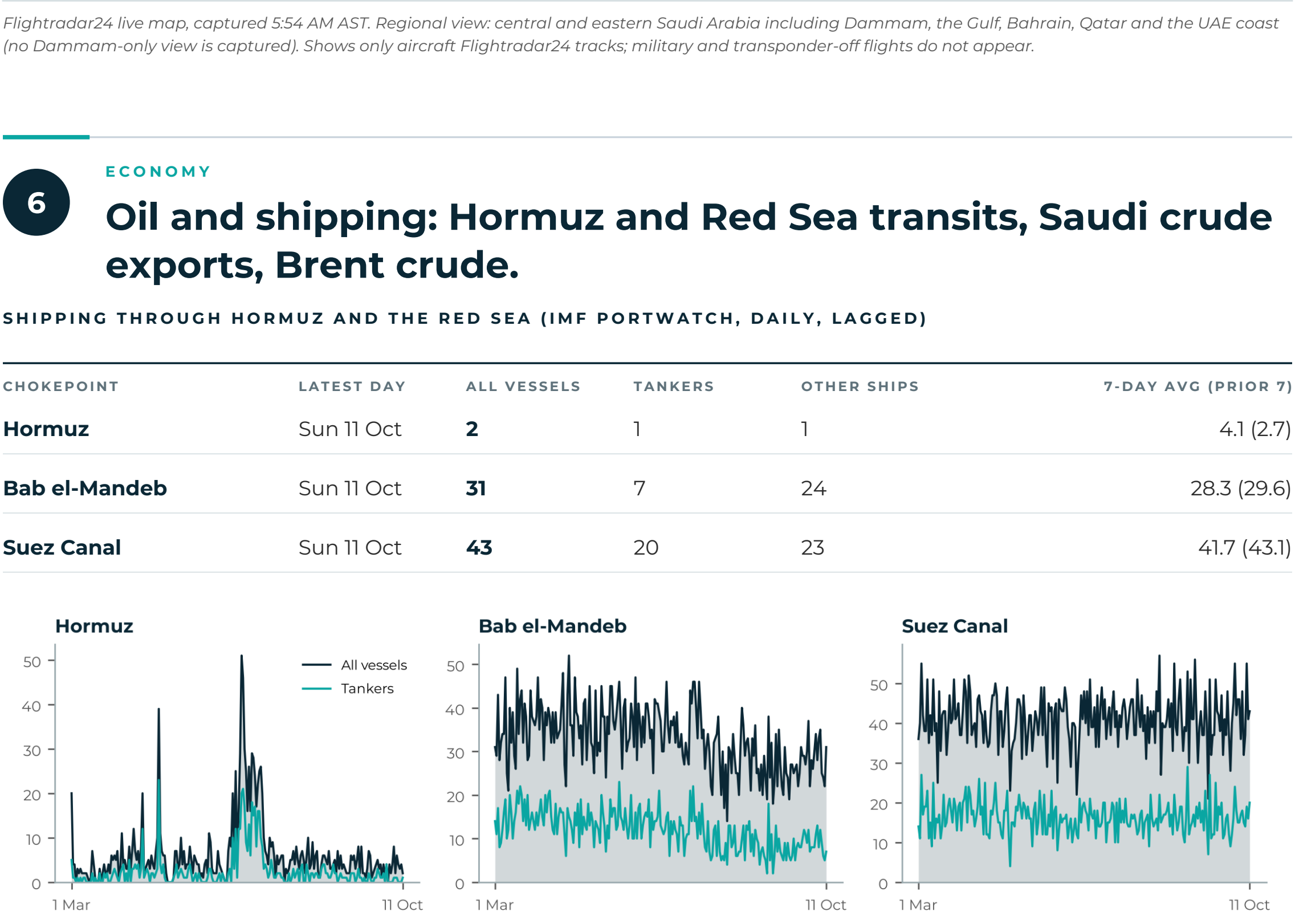
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 2:49–4:29 AM	100 min
Halt 1:15–2:04 AM	49 min
Halt 12:17–1:05 AM	48 min
Halt 9:42–11:11 PM	89 min
Halt 5:09–6:01 PM	53 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts claim air traffic halted at Dubai International, with inbound jets holding** (Social accounts on X (@CocoPostel, @abw__zayd) · 4:51 AM)

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



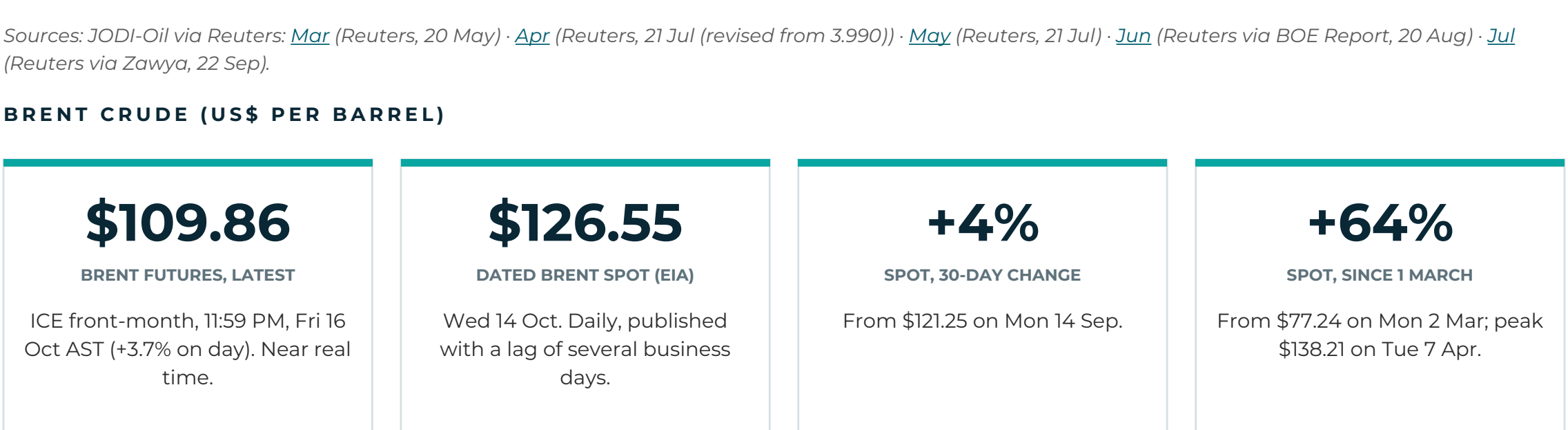
Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:54 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

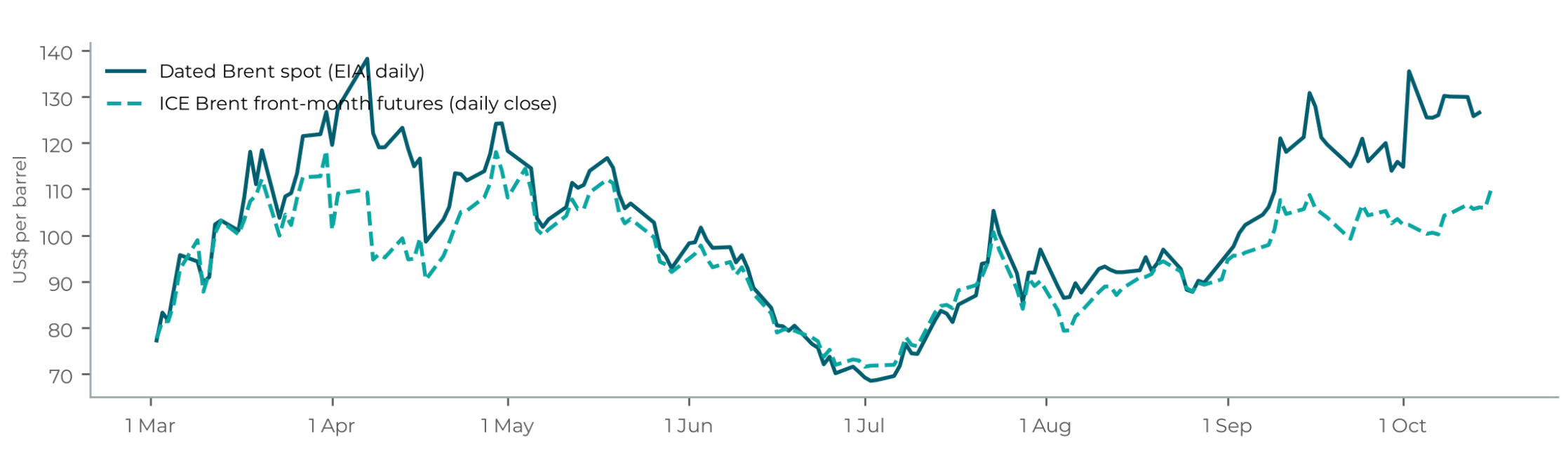
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 5:55 AM, Sun 18 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

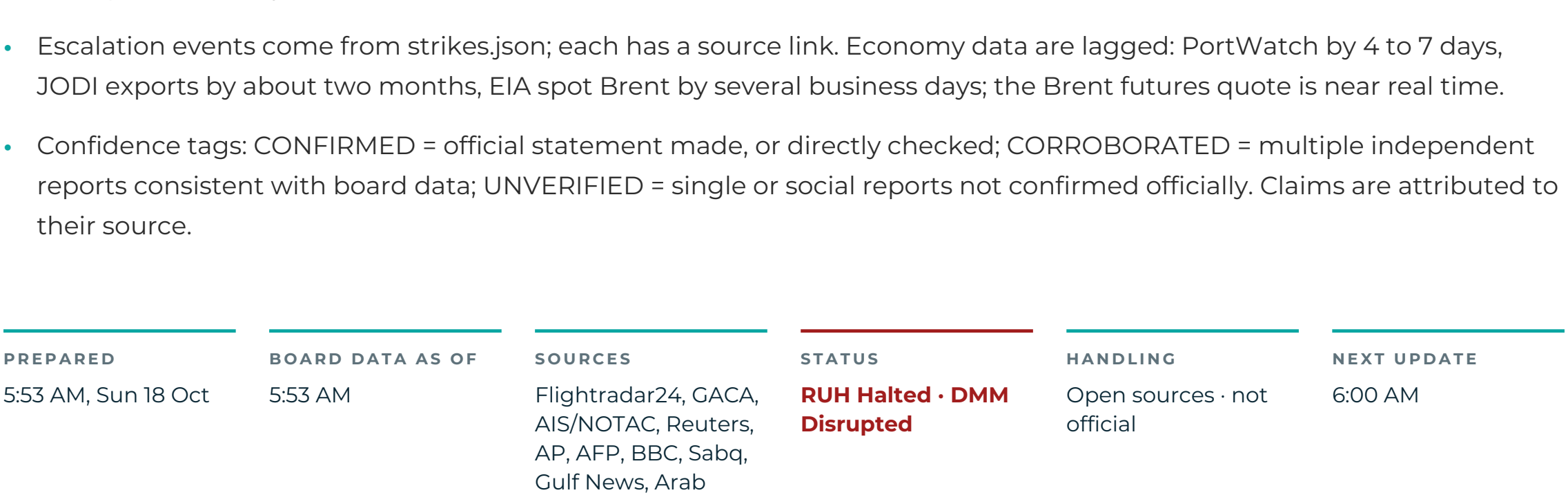


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.86	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 11:59 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST (+3.7% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 5:53 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
5:53 AM, Sun 18 Oct	5:53 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	6:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 6:00 AM